

Word family: **comic / comics / comical / comically / comedian / comedy**

Base word: comic

Plural: comics

Related forms: comical, comically

Closely related lexical family: comedy, comedian

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective (形容詞) / related adjective and noun forms (相關形容詞及名詞)

Your sentence:

> “We used to play football in the park, trade **comic books**, and ride our bicycles around the housing estate until sunset.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **comic** means a **publication or story told mainly through sequences of drawings, usually with written dialogue or captions**.

A **comic book** is therefore a book or magazine containing illustrated stories presented in panels.

繁體中文：***以連續圖畫、分格畫面、對話框和文字來講述故事的漫畫作品**

中文翻譯：

> “We used to ... trade **comic books**...”

「我們以前會.....互相交換**漫畫書**.....」

Here:

comic book = 以連續圖畫和文字講故事的漫畫書

1. **comic = illustrated story/publication (漫畫) — 漫畫 ; 漫畫刊物**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A story or publication presented mainly through a sequence of drawings, often with speech bubbles, captions, or other written text.

Practice 1 — Original

> “We used to trade **comic books**.”

「我們以前會互相交換**漫畫書**。」

Practice 2

> “He collected superhero **comics** when he was young.”

「他年輕時收藏超級英雄**漫畫**。」

Practice 3

> “This **comic** tells the story through very little dialogue.”

「這本**漫畫**主要用圖畫講故事，對話很少。」

****comic = 主要利用連續圖畫、分格和文字來敘述故事的作品或出版物****

Common:

- * comic book
- * comic strip
- * superhero comic
- * online comic
- * newspaper comic

These belong to one underlying ****illustrated narrative**** sense.

2. ****comic = comedian (人物) — 喜劇演員；搞笑藝人****

As a noun, ****comic**** can also mean a person whose job is to make audiences laugh, especially through jokes or humorous performance.

Practice 4

> “The club invited several well-known ****comics**** to perform.”

「這間俱樂部邀請了幾位著名****喜劇演員 / 棟篤笑藝人****表演。」

Practice 5

> “She started her career as a stand-up ****comic****.”

「她最初以棟篤笑****喜劇演員****的身分開始演藝事業。」

****a comic = 以講笑話或其他幽默表演令觀眾發笑的人****

This is genuinely different from:

> **a comic = 漫畫**

Context determines whether **comic** refers to:

- * an illustrated publication;
- * or a humorous performer.

3. **comic = humorous / intended to make people laugh (形容詞) — 滑稽的 ; 喜劇性的**

As an adjective, **comic** means connected with comedy or deliberately intended to be funny.

Practice 6

> “The actor has excellent **comic timing**.”

「那位演員有非常出色的**喜劇節奏感**。」

Practice 7

> “The film mixes serious drama with **comic** moments.”

「這部電影把嚴肅劇情和**喜劇 / 幽默場面**結合起來。」

****comic = 與喜劇有關，或刻意營造幽默、令人發笑效果的****

Common:

- * comic actor
- * comic scene
- * comic effect
- * comic timing
- * comic performance

This is a distinct adjective use.

4. **comic = amusing because something is absurd or unexpected (情況) — 滑稽的 ; 可笑的**

****Comic**** can also describe a situation that is funny because of its absurdity, contrast, or unexpectedness.

Practice 8

> “There was something almost **comic** about the confusion.”

「那場混亂中有一種幾乎令人覺得**滑稽可笑**的感覺。」

Practice 9

> “His attempt to remain serious had a **comic** effect.”

「他努力保持嚴肅的樣子反而產生了一種**滑稽效果**。」

comic = 因情況荒謬、反差強烈或出乎意料而產生幽默可笑的效果

For database counting, I would **merge** this with Meaning 3.

The core idea remains:

> **producing or relating to humour**

The difference is whether the humour is deliberately created or arises naturally from the situation.

The Golden Manual says different contexts should be merged when the same broader semantic idea naturally explains them.

Related form: **comical**

Comical means funny in a slightly absurd, silly, or ridiculous way.

Practice 10

> “He had a **comical** expression on his face.”

「他臉上的表情非常**滑稽可笑**。」

Practice 11

> “The dog looked rather **comical** in the oversized coat.”

「那隻狗穿着過大的外套，看起來相當**滑稽**。」

comical = 因外表、行為或情況顯得荒謬或有趣而令人發笑的

This overlaps with adjectival **comic**, but **comical** often more strongly suggests:

> **funny-looking / absurd / ridiculous**

rather than belonging professionally or artistically to comedy.

Related form: **comically**

Practice 12

> “The hat was **comically** large.”

「那頂帽子**大得很滑稽**。」

Practice 13

> “He reacted **comically** to the mistake.”

「他對那個錯誤的反應**滑稽得令人發笑**。」

comically = 以滑稽、荒謬或令人發笑的方式

Closely related form: **comedy**

Comedy is a useful lexical relative.

comedy = entertainment intended to make people laugh (喜劇)

Practice 14

> “She enjoys watching **comedy**.”

「她喜歡看**喜劇 / 搞笑節目**。」

Practice 15

> “The film is a romantic **comedy**.”

「這部電影是一部浪漫**喜劇**。」

comedy = 主要目的在於引人發笑的戲劇、電影、節目或表演類型

Closely related form: **comedian**

A **comedian** is a professional entertainer who makes people laugh.

Practice 16

> “The **comedian** told stories about everyday life.”

「那位**喜劇演員**講了一些有關日常生活的搞笑故事。」

Practice 17

> “She became one of the country's best-known **comedians**.”

「她成為該國最知名的**喜劇演員**之一。」

comedian = 以說笑話、喜劇表演或其他幽默內容令觀眾發笑的表演者

This overlaps strongly with:

> **comic — person**

but **comedian** is the clearer, more neutral general term.

Useful compound: **comic strip**

A **comic strip** is a short sequence of illustrated panels, often appearing in newspapers or online.

Practice 18

> “I used to read the **comic strip** in the newspaper every morning.”

「我以前每天早上都會看報紙上的**連環漫畫**。」

Practice 19

> “She publishes a weekly online **comic strip**.”

「她每星期在網上發布一篇**連環漫畫**。」

comic strip = 由少量連續分格構成、通常篇幅較短的漫畫

This belongs to the illustrated-story sense.

Important distinction: **comic** vs **comedian**

comic — noun

can mean:

> a comedian

comedian

is the more explicit general word for a professional comedy performer.

> “He is a stand-up comic.”

> “He is a comedian.”

Both are natural.

But **comic** also means:

> 漫畫

whereas **comedian** never does.

Important distinction: **comic** vs **comical**

These overlap but are not identical.

comic

often means:

* relating to comedy;

* deliberately humorous.

> “comic timing”

= 喜劇節奏

comical

usually means:

* funny because it looks absurd, silly, or ridiculous.

> “a comical expression”

= 滑稽的表情

So:

****comic = 喜劇性的 / 產生幽默效果的****

****comical = 看起來滑稽可笑的****

Important distinction: ****comic vs funny****

****funny****

is the broad everyday adjective meaning amusing or making people laugh.

****comic****

is often more connected to:

* comedy as a genre;

* performance;

* deliberate humorous effect.

> “a funny story”

very everyday.

> “comic performance”

more specifically a comedy performance.

Important distinction: ****comic vs cartoon****

These are related but not identical.

****comic****

usually tells a story through a sequence of illustrated panels.

cartoon

can mean:

- * one humorous drawing;
- * an animated film/programme;
- * a stylized drawing.

So:

> comic book ≠ cartoon automatically

A comic is typically **sequential illustrated storytelling**.

Important distinction: **comic vs graphic novel**

comic

is the broader category.

graphic novel

usually refers to a longer, book-length work told through comics/sequential art, often with a more extended narrative.

A graphic novel is generally a form of comic narrative, but not every comic is a graphic novel.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **comic**
- * **comics**
- * **comical**
- * **comically**

Closely related lexical family:

- * **comedy**

* **comedian**

Useful compounds include:

- * comic book
- * comic strip
- * comic actor
- * comic timing
- * comic effect
- * stand-up comic

The Golden Manual says useful related forms and compounds should be included when they add real learning value, but they should be labelled accurately rather than falsely counted as additional meanings of the base word.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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comic — illustrated narrative/publication	主要利用連續圖畫、分格、對話框和文字來敘述故事的漫畫作品或出版物
comic — person	以講笑話或其他幽默表演令觀眾發笑的喜劇演員
comic — adjective	與喜劇有關，或具有令觀眾發笑的幽默效果
comical	因外表、行為或情況顯得荒謬、滑稽而令人發笑的
comically	以滑稽、荒謬或令人發笑的方式
comedy	主要目的在於引人發笑的戲劇、電影、節目或表演類型
comedian	以說笑話、喜劇表演或其他幽默內容令觀眾發笑的表演者

For your original sentence

> “We used to ... trade **comic books**...”

The exact meaning is:

comic = 以連續圖畫、分格和文字來講述故事的漫畫

So:

comic book = 漫畫書

More specifically:

> **trade comic books**

= **互相交換漫畫書**

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely distinct core meanings** for **comic**:

1. **noun — comic / illustrated story or publication**
2. **noun — comedian / humorous performer**
3. **adjective — relating to comedy or producing a humorous effect**

I would merge **comic situation / comic effect / comic scene** under #3, and keep **comical, comedy, comedian**, and **comic strip** as family or lexical extensions rather than inflate the core count.